

SATHYA VIJAYAKUMAR

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SUMMARY	Strategist and applied economist (PhD + MBA) who blends consulting experience with analytical rigor to solve complex problems across strategy, M&A, and technology for executives and boards	
EXPERIENCE	THE WHARTON SCHOOL, UNIVERSITY OF PENNSYLVANIA	Philadelphia, PA
2026-Present	Lecturer – Strategic Management • Teach undergraduate and executive MBA courses on strategy and mergers & acquisitions that emphasize competitive analysis and financial valuation	
2019-2026	THE WHARTON SCHOOL, UNIVERSITY OF PENNSYLVANIA Doctoral Researcher – Strategy, Innovation, and M&A • Authored dissertation which pioneers research comparing private equity (PE) and corporate acquirer effects on tech companies. Analyzed 3,000+ acquisitions and 150,000+ inventors to show that PE and corporate acquirers select distinct targets and reshape target R&D using different levers – results with direct relevance for companies, investors, and policymakers • Engineered research-grade databases from administrative and archival sources, integrating multiple data streams into analysis-ready datasets. Fuzzy-matched ~1M patents, 46M citation records, and 5.1M trademark owners to firms for M&A/innovation research, and linked 1,800+ hand-classified shareholder proposals with SEC, lobbying, ESG, and financial data for investor-activism research • Designed novel statistical approaches combining causal inference and machine learning techniques to rigorously model corporate performance outcomes • Partnered with senior faculty at Penn Wharton and Dartmouth Tuck to translate findings into accessible frameworks suitable for the C-suite and boards of directors; presented work at major international conferences (e.g. Academy of Management, Strategic Management Society) • Served as Co-President of Wharton Doctoral Council 2022-24 representing 200+ PhD students to administration, co-chairing multiple global conferences, and founding 1st Year PhD Student Mentoring Program	Philadelphia, PA
2017-2019	COGNIZANT CONSULTING Senior Consultant – Digital Strategy Practice • Rated in the top 5% of Senior Consultants firmwide in final year; earned multiple C-suite client recognition letters for exceptional client impact • Created new financial modeling approach for large US telecom client to value knowledge management use cases resulting in identification of \$19M in revenue opportunities • Led a flagship Salesforce transformation for a large health insurer, launching 14 product releases across 5 sales lines of business; highlighted by Salesforce as a model payer engagement, supporting \$80M in projected net profit increase • Conducted process harmonization analysis for F100 pharmaceutical company resulting in recommendation to merge non-profit and for-profit drug divisions, accepted by client • Developed a mobile technology roadmap for a top global sports manufacturer, prioritizing 30+ use cases featuring augmented reality and advanced data analytics; roadmap was adopted to guide near-term investment decisions and pilots	Washington D.C.
2016	HEWLETT PACKARD ENTERPRISE MBA Intern – Health & Life Sciences Practice • Analyzed data democratization in healthcare across 5 global B2B segments resulting in identification of \$1.5B in health insurance market opportunities in China and Spain	Rochester Hills, MI

2011-2015

INITIATIVE FOR A COMPETITIVE INNER CITY

Boston, MA

Senior Analyst – Urban Business Initiatives

- Worked for nonprofit led by Dr. Michael Porter at Harvard Business School focused on urban economic development, CSR, strategy, and research
- Evaluated 400+ business applications to the Goldman Sachs 10,000 Small Businesses (10kSB) program in terms of growth potential, financial viability, and fit, resulting in 85 Scholars admitted to program
- Led flagship 2014 Inner City 100 CSR program from ideation to implementation, resulting in 20% shorter process, improved org-wide integration, and renewed buy-in from major funders. Promoted to manage new cross-functional team of 6, reporting weekly to CEO
- Managed cross-functional team to most successful urban business recruitment cycle since 2010, resulting in 20% more qualified applications despite 25% shorter timeline
- Led research on alternative capital sources for JPMorgan Chase white paper on financing barriers, resulting in a published resource guide used by small business intermediaries

EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF PENNSYLVANIA

Philadelphia, PA

The Wharton School

PhD, Managerial Science & Applied Economics, August 2026

MS, Managerial Science & Applied Economics, May 2024

- Concentration in Strategic Management
- Research Focus: Mergers & acquisitions, innovation, shareholder activism
- Methods: Econometrics, causal inference, machine learning, data engineering
- Dissertation: *Essays on Private Equity, Corporate Acquirers, and Technology Acquisitions*

UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN

Ann Arbor, MI

Stephen M. Ross School of Business, With Distinction

MBA, April 2017

- Concentrations in Strategy & Finance
- Awards: Randolph J. Agley Scholarship Recipient; 2nd Place 2015-16 Community Consulting Club Competition; Semifinalist 2015 Deloitte Case Competition

UNIVERSITY OF NORTH CAROLINA

Chapel Hill, NC

Kenan-Flagler Business School

BS, May 2011

ADDITIONAL

- Built and shipped NextUp, a Goodreads-style web app for TV shows, utilizing Claude Code
- Worked on microfinance projects and taught at a Ugandan orphanage in Summer 2009
- Ranked as one of the top 50 chess players in the US within age group 2002-05
- Hobbies: Fantasy football, running (5k-marathon), yoga, travel, community event planning
- Languages: English (native), Tamil (native), French (advanced)
- Technical Skills: Python, R, SQL, Stata, Excel (advanced), AI-assisted dev (e.g. Claude Code CLI)
- Test Scores: GMAT: 750 (98%)